



December 1, 2025

Search committee

Département des systèmes d'information et méthodes quantitatives de gestion (SIMQG)
École de gestion
Université de Sherbrooke

Re: Letter of Reference for Dr. Carlos Denner dos Santos – Tenure-Track Position in AI Management (Offer 07823)

Dear Members of the Search Committee,

It is with great enthusiasm that I write in strong support of Dr. Carlos Denner dos Santos's application for the tenure-track position in Gestion de l'intelligence artificielle at the Université de Sherbrooke. I have had the pleasure of collaborating with Dr. Santos since 2019 when he was presenting his work at the Hawaiian Conference on Systems Science (HICSS). I have had the privilege to collaborate with him through the [Jooay App](#), an internationally recognized digital platform designed to advance inclusive leisure participation among children and youth with disabilities. His contributions to this work have been foundational to the Jooay App research program, and directly aligned with the expertise identified in your position description—including AI governance, advanced analytics, responsible AI development, and AI-driven digital inclusion.

Dr. Santos joined the Jooay team as Co-Investigator in 2019 and later led the conception and engineering of our AI-based recommendation system, a system aimed at safely and ethically supporting families, clinicians, and community organizations in navigating leisure opportunities tailored to diverse accessibility needs. His ability to translate complex AI concepts into robust, secure, and operational solutions has been invaluable, especially given the sensitive nature of disability-related data and the need for transparency, safety, and equity in algorithmic decision-making. It was particularly important for our team, composed of health researchers, parents of children with disabilities and clinicians, with limited knowledge of technology and AI language, to have Dr. Santos acting as a trusted knowledge broker between the research team and the developers. His guidance and ability to translate end-users desirable features into complex code and system, and create front-end solutions that we could manage have been invaluable.

The position you are seeking to fill emphasizes AI governance, risk management, AIOps/MLOps, security and resilience of AI systems, and ethical integration of emerging AI methods—all of which are areas where Dr. Santos has demonstrated deep scientific and practical leadership. For Jooay,

he developed architectures that are fully consistent with state-of-the-art AI governance principles, including traceability, algorithmic transparency, risk mitigation, and user-centric design. His work ensured that the recommendation engine not only functioned effectively but also upheld the highest standards of privacy, accountability, and equity—concerns that are particularly salient for vulnerable populations.

In addition to his technical expertise, Dr. Santos has been a remarkable academic partner. He currently serves as an expert committee member for one of my doctoral students, providing thoughtful and rigorous feedback on AI-governance and ethical-AI methodology. His pedagogical clarity, generosity with students, and capacity to guide advanced conceptual discussion reflect his strengths as an educator and mentor. His interdisciplinary fluency—spanning information systems, AI engineering, ethics, and digital transformation—makes him exceptionally well-positioned to contribute to Sherbrooke’s programs at all levels.

I am also impressed by Dr. Santos’s prolific research record, including high-impact publications on a variety of topics, in addition to his practical work with industry, which provides him with a unique understanding of development and advances in the “real world”, which is something that we may loose touch with in academia, and seems extremely necessary, particularly for AI governance and scholarship that is grounded in fast-paced fields. His portfolio is perfectly aligned with the with the needs of a business school seeking leadership in responsible and applied AI. His ability to bridge conceptual theory, computational implementation, and real-world organizational impact is rare and extremely valuable.

Dr. Santos is not only an accomplished researcher and builder of AI systems—he is a dedicated collaborator, an ethical scholar, and a generous mentor. I have no doubt that he will become a key contributor to the École de gestion’s mission of training future leaders capable of shaping responsible and innovative AI ecosystems.

I offer him my strongest possible recommendation for this tenure-track position. Please do not hesitate to contact me should you require any further information.



Keiko Shikako, PhD, OT/erg

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